SahiKarigar

Validation Survey for Workers and Hirers

Version 1 · 4 October 2026 · Interviewer-administered in Hindi or local language · 15–20 minutes per interview

1. Before You Start

What this survey tests

Workers: Do they have gaps in work and unreliable ways of finding it? Can they use a link-based web app in Hindi? Will they pay ■50–100 a month?

Hirers: Is finding a trustworthy worker painful enough that they would switch to a platform, and will they pay for it?

Rules that keep the answers honest

1. **Ask about the past before the future.** “Last time you hired…” tells you more than “Would you hire…”.
2. **Do not mention SahiKarigar until the concept section.** Problem questions come first so you don't prime people.
3. **Rotate the order of options between interviews.** Always allow “Other” and “Don't know”.
4. **Read the concept card word for word, in the same neutral tone, to everyone.** Never add words like “great”, “easy” or “safe”.
5. **Interview workers away from their thekedar or employer.** Answers about payment and trust change when the boss is listening.
6. **A polite yes is not demand.** Every interview ends with a commitment ask (pilot sign-up). Count commitments, not compliments.
7. **For rating questions use a 5-point face scale** (■ to ■) so people who read little can answer by pointing.
8. **Take oral consent, keep answers anonymous,** and collect a phone number only if the person opts in to the pilot.
9. **Suggested sample:** about 50 workers (at least 8 per trade, mix of independent and thekedar-attached) and about 50 hirers (20 homeowners/tenants, 15 shopkeepers, 15 small contractors) across at least 2 towns. Include people who rarely use a smartphone.

2. Part A: Worker Survey

A0. Screener

W1. What work do you mainly do? Plumber / Electrician / Carpenter / Painter / Mistri (mason) / Tile or POP fitter / AC or appliance repair / Helper / Other. (Set quotas by trade.)

W2. Have you done this work for pay in the last 6 months? Yes / No. (If No, end the interview.)

W3. Do you work mostly on your own, mostly under a thekedar or contractor, or both?

W4. Years in this trade: under 2 / 2–5 / 6–10 / over 10.

W5. Age band: under 25 / 25–35 / 36–45 / over 45. (Note gender by observation.)

W6. Reading ability: cannot read / simple Hindi or local language / comfortable in Hindi or local language / also reads English.

A1. How they find work today

W7. How many days did you have paid work in the last 30 days? 0–10 / 11–15 / 16–20 / 21–25 / 26–30.

W8. In those 30 days, how many days did you want work but had none? 0–2 / 3–5 / 6–10 / more than 10.

W9. Think of your last five jobs. How did you get each one? (Multiple) Thekedar / Labour chowk (naka) / Past customer / Referral / Friend or fellow worker / Hardware, paint or electrical shop / WhatsApp group / Facebook or Instagram / App or website / Knocking on doors / Number on a wall, card or vehicle / Other.

W10. Which one source gave you the most work? Which gave the best-paying work?

W11. Do you pay anyone to get work (thekedar's cut, shop, middleman)? How much, in ₹ or %?

W12. In the last year, how many customers called you back for more work? None / 1–5 / 6–15 / more than 15.

W13. When work is slow, what do you usually do? Wait at the naka / Accept lower rates / Travel to another area / Take other kinds of work / Borrow money / Go back to the village / Other.

W14. Have you ever used an app or website to find work? Using now / Used and stopped / Never / Didn't know there were any. If used: which one, what worked, what didn't, why did you stop?

A2. Money, fears and trust

W15. Out of your last five jobs, how many paid in full on the same day? Within a week? Later than a week? Part payment or nothing?

W16. In the last 12 months, did any customer or contractor not pay, or pay less than agreed? Roughly how much was it?

W17. Which of these worries you most? Pick your top 3 and put them in order. Not getting enough work / Payment delayed or not paid / Customers bargaining too low / Injury or safety on the job / Being blamed for theft or damage / Disrespectful customers / No savings or insurance in slow months / Cost of tools and materials / Competition from other workers / Other.

W18. How do customers decide whether to trust you today? (Open. Probe: referral, ID, tools, appearance, shop reference.)

W19. Has anyone ever blamed you for theft, damage or bad work? What happened? (Optional. Skip if uncomfortable.)

W20. Which of these do you have? Aadhaar / Voter ID / PAN / Bank account / UPI / e-Shram card / Skill certificate / Photos of past work on your phone.

W21. If a service wanted to check your ID before showing you to customers, how would you feel? Comfortable / Comfortable only if… / Not comfortable (why).

A3. Phone and digital comfort

W22. Which phone do you use? Own smartphone / Shared smartphone / Keypad phone / None.

W23. How do you get internet? Monthly pack / Short packs when needed / Often no data / Wi-Fi only.

W24. Which do you use at least once a week? WhatsApp / YouTube / Facebook / Instagram / PhonePe, GPay or Paytm / Google Maps / Camera / Voice messages / Other.

W25. Is your phone storage often full? Never / Sometimes / Often. Did you delete an app to make space in the last month?

W26. How do you prefer to use messages? Read and type / Read only / Voice messages only / Ask family or a friend for help.

W27. In the last month, did you receive money from a customer by UPI? Yes / No / Don't use UPI.

W28. Observed task (CRITICAL - do not ask, observe). Send a test link on WhatsApp that opens a simple Hindi page with trade icons. Ask the person to open it and pick their trade. Record: completed alone / completed after one hint / needed help / could not complete, and the time taken. Also record whether the Hindi text was understood without help. This measures what people DO, not what they SAY.

A4. Concept test

Read aloud: "Sochiye, aapke phone par ek link khulta hai. Kuch download nahi karna. Usme aapka naam, kaam, ilaaka aur purane kaam ki photo hoti hai. Aapki pehchaan ki jaanch ho sakti hai. Aapke aas-paas jinhe aapke jaise karigar ki zaroorat hai, ve aapko dhoondhkar sampark kar sakte hain. Kaam ke baad graahak rating de sakte hain."

W29. How clear was that? (Face scale)

W30. How likely would you be to try this? (Face scale) Why?

W31. What is the best thing about it? What worries you?

W32. How do you feel about customers giving you a rating after a job? (Face scale + open)

W33. Would you want your name and work photos to be visible to nearby customers? Yes / Yes with conditions / No. Why?

W34. How would you prefer to use it? Customer calls you directly / Chat / You get a list and choose / Service assigns / Through WhatsApp.

W35. How many customer contacts in a month would make this useful for you? 1–2 / 3–5 / 6–10 / more than 10.

W36. What would have to be true before you trusted a service like this? (Open)

A5. Willingness to pay

W37. Price test (randomised). Each respondent sees ONE card: ■0 (control) / ■30 / ■50 / ■100 / ■150 per month. "Maan lijiye ye seva har mahine ■[price] mein aapke ilaake ke asli graahkon ke number dilati hai. Kya aap ye lenge?" Yes / No / Depends. If depends, on what?

W38. Which way of paying feels most acceptable? Free (hirer pays) / Small fee per lead / Monthly subscription / Commission after job / Pay only for guarantee. Why?

W39. If you had to pay after getting work, how much per job would be fair? ■10 / ■20 / ■30 / ■50 / % of job.

W40. Which one would make you most willing to pay? Guaranteed payment within 2 days / Rating that brings more work / ID badge that builds trust / No thekedar cut / Replacement if customer cancels / None.

W41. Would you pay ■99 for: ID verification + profile with photos + 5 customer contacts as trial?

W42. Do you currently pay for anything to get work? (Tool rental, shop commission, etc.) How much per month?

W43. Commitment ask. "We are starting a small trial in your area. May I note your number to send you the link when it is ready?" Yes / No. Would you refer another worker? Yes / No.

W44. Anything else you would like to tell us? (Open)

3. Part B: Hirer Survey

B0. Screener

H1. In the last 12 months, have you hired a plumber, electrician, carpenter, painter, mason, tile/POP fitter, AC or appliance repair for home, shop or site? Yes / No. (If No, end.)

H2. Which type? Homeowner or tenant / Shop or small business / Landlord or RWA / Small contractor or thekedar / Other.

H3. How many times in the last 12 months? 1–2 / 3–5 / 6–10 / more than 10.

H4. Usual job size: Small (under ■2000) / Medium (■2000–10000) / Large (over ■10000).

B1. How they find workers today

H5. Think of your last 3 hires. How did you find each worker? Past worker you knew / Friend/family recommendation / Neighbour / Hardware/paint/electrical shop / Labour chowk / Contractor / Google search / Justdial / Urban Company / Facebook/WhatsApp group / Other.

H6. Which source do you trust most? Which is fastest?

H7. How long did it take to find someone for your last job? Same day / 1–2 days / 3–7 days / More than a week.

H8. How many workers did you call or meet before you chose one? 1 / 2–3 / 4 or more.

H9. Have you ever paid extra to get someone quickly? How much?

H10. Have you used an app or website to hire? Using now / Used and stopped / Never / Didn't know any. If used: which, what worked, what didn't?

B2. Pain, trust and money

H11. How much do you worry about each? (Face scale) Worker not showing up / Bad quality / Overcharging / Theft or damage / Safety / Not being able to find someone again if needed.

H12. Think of your last 5 hires. In how many did something go wrong? What went wrong?

H13. What does one no-show or bad job cost you? (Time, money, stress - open)

H14. How do you check whether a worker you have never met is trustworthy today? (Open. Probe: ID, referral, shop reference, photos, bill, etc.)

H15. When you invite an unknown worker into your home/shop, what worries you most? (Open)

H16. Has a worker ever done theft, damage or very bad work in your home/shop? What happened? (Optional)

H17. How do you usually agree on price? Fixed before / Per day / After seeing work / Material plus labour / Other.

H18. How often does the final price end up higher than first agreed? Never / Sometimes / Often.

H19. If a job is not done well, who pays to fix it? Worker / You / Shared / Depends.

H20. When something goes wrong after a job, what do you usually do? Call same worker back / Find someone else / Pay to fix it / Argue or complain / Let it go.

B3. Concept test

Read aloud: “Imagine a service you open from a link on your phone. Nothing to download. Workers on it have had their ID checked. Each has a profile with trade, experience, photos of past work and ratings from earlier customers. You say what work you need, see workers near you with their ratings and usual rates, and contact one. After the job you can rate them.”

H21. How clear was that? (Face scale)

H22. How likely would you be to use it the next time you need a worker? (Face scale) Why?

H23. For each of these, how much more would you trust a worker you have never met? No difference / A little / A lot. (Rotate) ID checked by the service / Ratings from earlier customers / Photos of past work / Police verification / Worker's photo and local address / Service guarantee for damage or no-show / A neighbour's recommendation.

H24. How much would you trust ratings from strangers? (Face scale) Would you leave a rating after a job? Yes / No / Maybe.

H25. Choice test (CRITICAL). “For a one-day job, which would you hire?” A: ID-verified, 4.5 stars from 30 customers, ■800 / B: not verified, recommended by your neighbour, ■650 / C: not verified, no ratings, ■500. Ask why. Then repeat with A at ■700 and ask whether the answer changes.

H26. What would have to be true before you trusted a service like this? (Open)

H27. How would you prefer to use it? Call the worker directly / Chat / Book a time slot / The service sends someone / Through WhatsApp / Through a phone helpline.

H28. How comfortable are you with: opening a link, entering an OTP, paying through UPI inside the service? (Face scale for each)

B4. Willingness to pay

H29. Which way of paying for a service like this feels most acceptable? Free for you (worker pays) / A small fixed fee per booking / A percentage added to the job cost / A monthly subscription / Pay only for a guarantee. Why?

H30. Price test (randomised). Each respondent sees one card: ■0 (control) / ■30 / ■50 / ■99 per booking. “If the worker is ID-verified and rated, would you pay ■[price] on top of the worker's charge?” Yes / No / Depends. If it depends, on what?

H31. Would you pay more than the normal rate to a verified and rated worker? No / Up to 10% / 10–20% / More than 20%.

H32. (For shops, landlords, contractors and anyone who hires every month) Would you pay a monthly subscription of ■[randomise: 99 / 199 / 299 / 499] for reliable access to verified workers? Yes / No / Depends.

H33. Which one would make you most willing to pay? A replacement if the worker doesn't show up / Free redo within 7 days / Damage cover / Same-day arrival / Fixed, published rates / None of these.

H34. Contractors only. How many workers do you hire in a month? How do you find them? What does one no-show cost you (days of delay or ■)? Would you source regular or bulk needs through a service like this?

H35. Commitment ask. “We are starting a small trial in your area. May I note your number to send you the link when you next need a worker?” Yes / No. Would you recommend it to a neighbour or colleague? Yes / No.

H36. Monthly household or business income band (optional).

H37. Anything else you would like to tell us? (Open)

4. Reading the Results

These thresholds are rules of thumb, not industry standards. Decide your own cut-offs before fieldwork so the results can't bend your judgement. Stated willingness to pay usually overstates real behaviour, so expect actual conversion to be roughly half of what people say. Cut the results by trade, thekedar-attached versus independent, town, smartphone user versus not, and hirer segment (home, shop, contractor).

Three things to look for beyond the averages

1. **Who pays.** If workers refuse ■50 but hirers accept a ■30–50 fee, consider charging hirers, or a small commission after the job, instead of a worker subscription.
2. **The supply and demand loop.** Workers will pay only if leads actually arrive. Compare the contacts workers need (W35) with how often hirers hire (H5, H7). Plan to build hirer demand in a few neighbourhoods first.
3. **The say-do gap.** Pilot sign-ups and the observed link task (W28) matter more than stated likelihood or stated prices.

Signal	Encouraging	Warning
Workers: days wanted work but had none (W8)	6+ days for 40%+ of workers	Under 25%
Workers: link task (W28)	60%+ finish with at most one hint	Under 40%
Workers: likely to try (W30)	50%+ pick top two faces	Under 30%
Workers: accept ■50 a month (W37)	40%+	Under 20%
Workers: pilot sign-up (W43)	40%+	Under 20%
Hirers: at least one no-show or quality issue in last 5 hires (H14)	40%+	Under 20%
Hirers: pick verified worker at higher price (H25)	50%+	Under 25%
Hirers: accept ■30–50 fee (H30)	30%+	Under 15%
Hirers: pilot sign-up (H35)	30%+	Under 15%

5. Appendix: Hindi Wording for Key Questions

Have a native speaker adjust these for local dialect and for other regional languages.

- **Worker concept card:** “[redacted]”
- **W15 (payment):** “[redacted]?”
- **W21 (ID check):** “[redacted]?”
- **W32 (rating):** “[redacted]?”
- **W37 (price):** “[redacted]?”
- **H15 (fear):** “[redacted]?”
- **H30 (price):** “[redacted]?”